

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing

PAPER 3 Listening

PAPER 4 Speaking

Part 1

Part 2

Part 3

Part 4

Essential tips

- ▶ Read carefully through each question before the recording is played. Think about what you are going to hear. Practising the strategy of prediction will increase your chances of successful listening.
- ▶ One of the objectives in this part of the test is identifying how the speaker feels. Remember to listen for adjectives that describe feelings and attitudes. You should also pay attention to the speaker's tone of voice, which will provide you with clues as to how he or she feels.
- ▶ Remember that the questions and answer options may be paraphrased, that is, they may use different words from the ones used by the speakers. Pay close attention to the meaning expressed rather than waiting to hear the same words and expressions in the recording.

Question 1: It is clear that the woman did not challenge her friend, but what was the reason for this? How would you describe her attitude to the whole situation?

Question 2: Pay close attention to the language used in the answer options. Can you find the same meaning, perhaps expressed using different words, anywhere in the recording?

Question 6: Note that you need to look for a point of agreement here. Does the man or woman mention anything about agreeing with the other one?

Track 1

You will hear three different extracts. For questions 1–6, choose the answer (A, B or C) which fits best according to what you hear. There are two questions for each extract.

Extract One

You overhear two friends discussing an incident that happened with another friend.

- 1 The woman did not challenge the friend because she
 - ✗ A feels her friend is aggressive.
 - ✗ B doesn't believe it would help.
 - C thinks her friend would be hurt.
- 2 What does the man think the woman should do?
 - A Say something immediately.
 - B Back down and just let it go.
 - ✗ C Discuss the issue rationally.

Extract Two

You hear two people discussing the British winter.

- 3 The woman says she dislikes the British winter because she
 - A comes from the Mediterranean.
 - B doesn't have the right clothes.
 - ✗ C finds it much too cold and dark.
- 4 From the man's point of view, the British winter is
 - ✗ A just long enough.
 - B not long enough.
 - C a little too long.

Extract Three

You hear a couple disagreeing about Valentine's Day.

- 5 What is the man's main complaint about the event?
 - A He is upset because he can't afford it.
 - ✗ B He is annoyed by the selfishness of it all.
 - C He hates champagne and chocolates.
- 6 What point are the couple in agreement on?
 - ✗ A that Valentine's Day is really a money-making scheme
 - B that they should go to a restaurant on Valentine's Day
 - C that Valentine's Day is an important, romantic occasion

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 Track 2

You will hear a radio producer describing how she got into her career. For questions 7–14, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

BECOMING A RADIO PRODUCER

Tara Blackshaw was asked to talk to the audience about her

(7) *career path*

Tara explains that studying media or journalism at university

was not (8) *the road route* she took.

She doesn't necessarily think it's a bad idea to do a

(9) *degree media-based degree*, but it's not a requirement.

Finding and pursuing a career in an area they are passionate about

is the one thing Tara wants the audience members to

(10) *decide what you love doing take away* from the talk.

Tara was not discouraged by the fact that the training programme at her local radio

station was (11) *unpaid*

She describes how certain she was that she had found her ideal job as soon as she

(12) *set a foot* in the studio.

Fifteen years before, Tara had relocated to London and was

(13) *recruited* for her current job.

Tara describes the work as a (14) *labour of love producer needs to be an ideas person*

because it can be challenging and difficult, but also very rewarding.

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Essential tips

- ▶ Always read the instructions carefully.
- ▶ One focus of this part of the test is listening for specific information. Look at the sentences and pay attention to their structure. This will help you to identify the parts of speech you may need to complete each one.
- ▶ Remember that each gap may be completed by a number, a word, or a phrase.
- ▶ The subject of the recording is provided in a heading at the top of the page. By reading it, you can make predictions about what you are going to hear, and begin to think about all the vocabulary you know related to that topic.
- ▶ The recording will be played twice. Try to complete each sentence the first time, and confirm your answers the second time.

Question 8: What does Tara say about her own experience of studying media or journalism at university?

Question 10: The word *to* appears before the gap. What part of speech do you need here? Don't forget that you may need more than one word. Pay attention to see if a phrasal verb is used by the speaker.

Question 11: What could, potentially, have been a discouraging aspect of the work experience programme at the radio station (but wasn't for Tara)?

Question 13: What does Tara say about moving to London and the job she is in now?

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 Track 3

You will hear two friends, Fiona and Matthew, discussing an interview which featured an American skier and filmmaker called Nick Waggoner. For questions 15–20, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which fits best according to what you hear.

Essential tips

- ▶ One of the things you will be asked in this part of the exam is to identify attitude and opinion. As always, listen carefully to what the speakers say, but pay attention to how they say it as well.
- ▶ The questions here are multiple-choice with four answer options. Remember, you may hear items from all four options mentioned in the recording, but listen carefully to identify the one that answers the question correctly.
- ▶ The instructions will tell you the topic of the recording. Take a minute to think about any vocabulary you know related to that topic.

Question 16: This question asks you about Fiona's attitude at the beginning of the conversation. How does she sound to you? Which of the options best matches her tone of voice?

Question 18: Without listening to the recording, any of these options could be possible, but remember to listen for what the speaker specifically states.

Question 20: You already know from the question that Nick describes how making ski films affects him. Only one of the options is correct, and he may express this idea using different words. What does he say about how the process makes him feel?

- 15 What is Matthew doing when Fiona arrives at the coffee shop?
 - A He has started reading the interview.
 - B He is in the middle of reading the interview.
 - ☒ C He has finished reading the interview.
 - D He is thinking about reading the interview.
- 16 What is Fiona's reaction to the topic, at first?
 - A genuinely curious about it
 - B completely bored with it
 - C totally fascinated by it
 - ☒ D not that interested in it
- 17 What made Nick Waggoner choose the location for his film *Solitaire*?
 - A It was suitable for using a helicopter.
 - B He liked the challenge it would provide.
 - ☒ C It had the most dramatic landscapes.
 - D The snow conditions were perfect there.
- 18 What was the impact of Arne Backstrom's death on Nick and Zac?
 - A It was OK as they didn't know Arne well.
 - ☒ B It affected Nick and Zac very deeply.
 - C They decided to abandon the project.
 - D They were not entirely surprised by it.
- 19 What did Nick and Zac do after Arne's death?
 - A They learned how to fly a plane.
 - B They connected with other colleagues.
 - C They moved the film dates forward.
 - ☒ D They learned how to paraglide.
- 20 How does Nick describe the effect that making ski films has on him?
 - ☒ A He says it energises him.
 - B He says it bores him.
 - C He says he doesn't like it.
 - D He says it frightens him.

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Essential tips

- ▶ Part 4 of the Listening paper is a matching exercise. There are three additional options that you will not need.
- ▶ You are required to do two tasks at the same time in this part of the test. Read the instructions and make sure you understand exactly what you will need to listen for in each task.
- ▶ The five speakers will speak on the same theme. Pay attention to the main points and attitudes they express.
- ▶ Remember, the options do not appear in the order in which they are heard on the recording.

Questions 21–25:

Option A: If someone avoids writing, what kinds of words might they use to express this?

Option D: Who, if anyone, mentions their own opinion of their writing?

Option H: For this option to be correct, someone must mention how often they write. What sorts of words should you listen for here?

Questions 26–30:

Option B: This option mentions 'enthusiasm', which may or may not be the exact word used in the recording. Does any speaker use words or phrases with the same meaning to describe their experience in the writers' group?

Option F: What kind of tone of voice do you think someone would use if they felt the writing group members were 'harsh critics'?

Option G: This option provides you with two clues before you listen. You know you need to identify a speaker who mentions the feedback they get in the writers' group and the amount they get. What does 'constructive' mean? Does anyone express this idea?



Track 4

You will hear five short extracts in which people talk about being in writers' groups.

While you listen you must complete both tasks.

TASK ONE

For questions 21–25, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about their own writing.

A tends to avoid writing		
B panics under pressure	Speaker 1	C 21
C finds the process isolating	Speaker 2	F 22
D is satisfied with their own work	Speaker 3	H 23
E feels it's a waste of time	Speaker 4	A 24
F had been out of practice	Speaker 5	D 25
G never finishes anything		
H writes every day		

TASK TWO

For questions 26–30, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about their experience of being in a writer's group.

A enjoys the positive feedback		
B gets the enthusiasm they need	Speaker 1	AB 26
C looks forward to the social aspect	Speaker 2	BA 27
D doesn't like the group leader	Speaker 3	G 28
E finds the motivation to keep writing	Speaker 4	E 29
F thinks the members are harsh critics	Speaker 5	F 30
G minds the lack of constructive feedback		
H struggles to find time to attend		

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